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Dear editors,

I am hereby submitting the article, "ITMO Regulations to Ratchet up Ambition," for publication as a *Perspective* in *Global Environmental Change*.

I followed your invitation to resubmit my article "Beyond Current Initiatives: ITMO Regulations to Ratchet up Ambition" as a *Perspective* instead of an *Article*. As I had to cut more than half of the paper, I chose to scrap Section 1 (a critical assessment of the current international climate policy regime), as well as Section 3 and Appendix Tables (comparative assessment of proposals to reinforce the international climate policy regime).

While my previous submission included a pedagogical overview of current and proposed international climate policies, the current submission focuses on original proposals and is intended for experts. This paper aims to have impact beyond academic circles and to reach climate negotiators.

I still believe that parts cut from the previous submission deserve publication (e.g. the critique of the *fossil fuel non-proliferation treaty*, that is the main demand of the climate movement) and I am wondering whether *Global Environmental Change* would be a suitable outlet for another *Perspective* on these issues, or if I should prepare this new paper for another journal.

In the paper submitted here, after explaining the risks of weakened domestic action posed by the unfettered use of Internationally Transferred Mitigation Outcomes (ITMOs) allowed by the Article 6.2 of the Paris Agreement, I show how ITMOs could contribute to a ratcheting up of ambition if a coalition of the willing countries subject their use to stricter rules. I sketch proposals with increasing degrees of ambition. In the most ambitious one, the coalition would submit a joint NDC, aligned with the Paris target, and coalition members would commit not to trade ITMOs with countries outside the coalition.

I am preparing another companion paper, which I also hope to publish in *Global Environmental Change*, where I will detail how a coalition could allocate emissions rights (or NDC targets) between its members and propose a new allocation rule aimed to be acceptable to most parties. This companion paper will simulate distributive effects at the decade-country-decile level and show that, when complemented with domestic income redistribution, the proposed agreement would make a majority of the population better-off in every country, despite substantial North-to-South transfers compared to the status quo.

Sincerely,

Dr. Adrien Fabre

